Legacy of *the Twenty-Six*

A Documented History of How the Board Has Governed Membership, 1891 – 2026.

A Responsibility *Inherited.*

The Club exists because every generation inherited something worth protecting.

Every generation of MAC leadership has inherited the same responsibility: preserve the character of the Club while adapting it for the next generation. Across 135 years the mechanisms of membership have changed — the initiation fee, the category, the closure, the waitlist, the lottery, the pipeline. The principles beneath them have not.

ANCHOR QUOTATION

“MAC has continuously adapted the mechanisms of membership while preserving the principles of stewardship.”

— Book Report, pp. 1, 7 (synthesis of *Legacy of the Twenty-Six*, 1991)

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), framing chapters; Book Report pp. 1, 7.

A NOTE ON METHOD

Discipline of language.
Source on every page.

This deck reads MAC's 135-year membership record through one lens: Board stewardship. Every claim is tagged by the kind of claim it is — and every slide names the source it draws from.

The foundation source for 1891–1991 is *Legacy of the Twenty-Six*. The modern record (1991–2026) draws on the institutional archive: Board minutes, Bylaws, Lottery Reports, Big Draw documents, category FAQs, and the 2026 Pipeline / Proposer / Membership Health frameworks.

Where the record is silent or disagrees with itself, this deck says so plainly.

FRAMEWORK

Four labels. One method.

HISTORICAL RECORD

A documented fact: a date, a figure, a person, a Board action, drawn from a named source.

DOCUMENTED CONDITION

The state of the Club at a moment in time — economic, demographic, capacity, regulatory.

INSTRUMENT USED

A specific mechanism the Board deployed: a fee, a category, a closure, a waitlist, a lottery, a framework.

INTERPRETATION

A synthesis the record supports but does not state outright. Marked plainly when used.

Source: Method, editorial direction, June 2026 · Source register on every content slide.

THE GOVERNING THESIS

The historical record demonstrates that MAC has repeatedly adapted its membership mechanisms in response to changing conditions *while preserving its enduring stewardship responsibility* to both current and future members.

FIVE STEWARDSHIP RESPONSIBILITIES THE RECORD TRACES ACROSS 135 YEARS

01

Steward the members already here

02

Preserve dues stability

03

Protect community character

04

Manage capacity and access

05

Prepare the Club for the next generation

Source: Thesis per editorial direction, June 2026.

HOW TO READ EACH SECTION

Four questions.
Five sections.
One responsibility.

01

What condition did the historical record document?

THE STATE OF THE CLUB

02

What mechanism did MAC use?

THE INSTRUMENT DEPLOYED

03

What stewardship responsibility was being balanced?

WHOSE INTEREST WAS AT STAKE

04

What does this teach the Board today?

THE INHERITED RESPONSIBILITY

Source: Section framework, editorial direction, June 2026.

Across 135 years, *five commitments never changed.*

ONE

Belonging.

A community you earn a place within.

TWO

Stewardship.

Care for what was inherited.

THREE

Fairness.

One standard at the door.

FOUR

Sustainability.

Dues, capacity, character, held in balance.

FIVE

Long-term thinking.

The Club that outlasts its founders — and the Board too.

The mechanisms changed. The philosophy did not.

Source: *Legacy of the Twenty-Six* (1991), framing chapters; Book Report pp. 1, 7.

THE RECURRING CYCLE · DEMAND → STUDY → EXPANSION → CATEGORIES → DEMAND

Every capacity peak has been met by *a Board response.*

1891	1908	1925	1950s	1960s	1971	1981	2026
Founding *26 → 200*	Intermediate category	Institutional maturation era	Postwar growth *8,700 by 1957*	Waitlist lengthens *7–8 yrs by 1968*	Modernization computer terminal	Goose Hollow accord *~20,000 cap*	**Membership Health**

INTERPRETATION

"Every capacity peak has been met by a Board response — a study, a category, a cap, or a queue."

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), pp. 22, 31, 109, 117, 132, 152, 158; 2026 Board deck.

LONG-RANGE PLANNING AS A THROUGH-LINE

Governance was *strategic, not reactive.*

1894	*Special Committee created to process nomination influx.* Book Report, p. 2
1971	*Modernization: computer-based all-charge system, $7,350.* Legacy, p. 132
1981	*Goose Hollow accord — voluntary ~20,000 cap by year 2000, negotiated with neighbors.* Legacy, pp. 152, 158
1982 – 2020	*Eleven audited lottery cycles — a standing capacity mechanism.* 2011 SPC Report [S-01]; 2020 Lottery Reports [S-08, S-09]
2021	*Bylaws Amendment §2 — codified three pathways.* Bylaws, amended Feb 26, 2021
2026	*Pipeline Subcommittee, Membership Health framework.* June 2026 Board deck

INTERPRETATION

Board planning has been continuous, deliberate, and long-horizon — not merely reactive.

Sources: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991); Book Report; 2011 SPC [S-01]; 2020 Reports [S-08, S-09]; MAC Bylaws §2 (amended Feb 26, 2021); June 2026 Board deck.

Building the *Institution.*

Condition. Portland, 1891: a fast-growing city, no permanent athletic institution.
Mechanism. Cash threshold, articles of incorporation, category creation.
Stewardship. Define a community capable of outlasting its founders.
Lesson. The Club was designed to be permanent from day one. Every later policy inherited that intent.

HISTORICAL RECORD · FEB 5, 1891 · COLUMBIA HALL

The twenty-six walked out over *ten dollars.*

26

FOUNDERS

Around 150 men had gathered at Columbia Hall to form an athletic club. Most wanted the new club to accept membership in kind — old, tattered football uniforms — as initiation. A breakaway group of twenty-six men, led by photographer **Arthur B. McAlpin, age 34**, refused.

They insisted on a **cash initiation fee of $10**. The 26 walked. Articles of incorporation were drafted on February 26, 1891 and filed two days later in Salem.

> *"When we started the club... clubs were being organized in San Francisco. We organized strictly as an amateur..."*
>
> — A. B. McAlpin, recalling the founding

What the founding fixes — and what every later membership decision in the book inherits — is the principle that paying to belong is the threshold. From day one the Club is a paying community.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 16, p. 18, p. 19.

INSTRUMENT USED · MARCH 26, 1891 · PRICING FOR DEMAND

From 26 to 200 — *and the fee doubled.*

MEMBERSHIP

200

within thirty days of incorporation

INITIATION FEE

$25

raised from $10 — more than doubled

BY COMPARISON

A weekly wage in 1891.

The book notes the $25 fee was “more than an average weekly wage.” (p. 157)

THE INSTRUMENT, OBSERVED. *When the line gets long, the price moves. The Club did not cap headcount — it priced for it. The first documented response to demand in the book's hundred-year history.*

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 22, p. 157.

INSTRUMENT USED · 1891 – 1908 · CATEGORY DESIGN

Membership at the Club was *never a single thing.*

1891

JUNIOR GUESTS

Bylaws amended to allow "junior guests" to use the facilities. The first crack in a single-tier model, arriving within the founding year.

1892

JUNIOR MEMBERSHIP

Formal junior membership established for sons and brothers of members, and for young men with no immediate relative in the Club.

1908

INTERMEDIATE

Board member **Edgar E. Frank** creates the intermediate classification for young men 18–21 — a bridge category between junior and senior status.

A tiered system, calibrated to age and family relationship. In retrospect, this is the architecture that would carry the Club through Depression, two world wars, and the lottery era.

Source: *Legacy of the Twenty-Six* (1991), p. 22, p. 31.

INSTRUMENTS USED · 1899 DRIVE & 1900 – 1909 CLOSURES

Recruit when you can.
Close when you can't.

JUNE 1899

First membership drive.

The book records "an active campaign" that produced a dramatic increase in membership. The first explicit membership drive in the Club's history. Recruiting was already an organized activity, not a function of word of mouth — *the mechanism: a campaign. The result: a recorded surge.*

1900 – 1909

Closure as capacity.

Junior membership "closed on more than one occasion" simply because the facilities could not absorb them all. Not a waiting list. Not a price increase. *A hard close. The Club would use this lever repeatedly across the next ninety years.*

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 23, p. 31.

INSTRUMENT USED · THE GREAT WAR · DUES SUSPENSION

A new instrument: *paused membership.*

1,065

CLUB VOLUNTEERS IN UNIFORM

"Almost half of active senior members and more than a fifth of the club total." (p. 73)

26

LOST THEIR LIVES

A gold star for each. The book notes the symmetry with the twenty-six founders.

Dues waived

FOR MEMBERS ON ACTIVE DUTY

The Club did not drop members for non-payment during military service. It paused them.

The instrument would be reinstated, by the same name — service-suspense membership — in October 1940, before American entry into the Second World War.

Source: *Legacy of the Twenty-Six* (1991), p. 73.

Permanence was the founding decision — *every later policy inherited it.*

01 · CONDITION

Portland, 1891. A city expanding past 50,000. Multiple short-lived athletic societies. No permanent institution. The 26 walked over whether commitment would be required at the door.

02 · MECHANISM

Cash initiation fee ($10 → $25). Articles of incorporation. Junior / intermediate / Ladies Annex categories. Dues suspension for service.

03 · STEWARDSHIP BALANCE

Protect the seriousness of the institution against dilution — while keeping the door open to the next generation (juniors) and to the missing half of the community (women).

04 · LESSON FOR THE BOARD TODAY

The institution was designed to outlast its founders. Every later mechanism — freezes, lotteries, pipelines — inherited that intent. *The work of stewardship begins with the assumption that the Club will still exist in 2126.*

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), pp. 16, 22, 31, 36, 73 · Stewardship framing per editorial direction (June 2026).

Protecting the *Institution.*

Condition. 25% loss after 1929. Federal 10% dues tax. World war. The Club at 550 paying members against a 1,250 break-even.

Mechanism. Family membership. A dedicated retention hire. Service-suspense. Deck-wide closures. The first waitlist.

Stewardship. Hold the institution through shock. Preserve dues stability without abandoning members who could not pay.

Lesson. In crisis, the Board's tools are retention, suspension, and category design — not abandonment.

A quarter of the base — *gone.*

400

MEMBERS LOST IN THREE MONTHS

"Some 400 departing in the three months following the October 1929 stock market crash." (p. 70)

25%+

CUMULATIVE LOSS FROM PEAK

"The club had lost more than 25 percent of its membership." (p. 70)

550

STABLE BASE AT THE TROUGH

1,250 *senior members were needed to prosper.*

DOCUMENTED CONDITION

A federal 10 percent tax on club dues further discouraged members. Account delinquencies mounted; so did club debt. By 1930, members were openly debating whether to sell Multnomah Stadium.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 70.

INSTRUMENT USED · 1932 · FAMILY-CLASS CATEGORY CREATED

One bundled membership *per household.*

1932

FAMILY MEMBERSHIP CREATED

THE ECONOMIC LOGIC

By selling one bundled membership to a household, the Club could *capture more dues from each address* while reducing per-person administrative friction.

THE SOCIAL LOGIC

Family membership made MAC a *family club rather than a men's club.* A secondary consequence in the book — but the category persists in some form to this day.

One of the most consequential category innovations in the book's entire 100-year span — a Depression-era invention that reshaped the demographic foundation of the Club permanently.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 75.

INSTRUMENT USED · 1933 · FIRST DEDICATED RETENTION ROLE

The first dedicated *membership retention role.*

HIRED BY THE CLUB · 1933

Emil Piluso.

“To reduce fluctuations by introducing new members more fully to club activities.”

— *Legacy of the Twenty-Six*, p. 75

WHAT'S NEW ABOUT THIS HIRE

Piluso's role was *not recruiting — it was onboarding and integration.*

This is the **first documented articulation of retention as a discrete job function at MAC** — the intellectual ancestor of today's onboarding philosophy.

The Club had figured out, in the depths of the Depression, that the cost of acquiring a member was greater than the cost of keeping one engaged. A 21st-century insight, executed in 1933.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 75; Book Report p. 5.

INSTRUMENTS USED · 1930S · FEE FLUIDITY & INSTITUTIONAL REFRAME

The fee as a variable. *The name, redefined.*

INITIATION FEE FLUIDITY

$2.50 – $5.50 / mo

"During most of the [1930s] no initiation fee was charged if a new member paid the first three months' dues — typically $2.50 to $5.50 a month — in advance."

The fee was reinstated in the late 1930s, *"further stabilizing membership."*

1936 · BYLAWS MODERNIZED

MAAC → MAC

The word *amateur* — once central to the Club's identity in opposition to professional sport — was dropped.

By 1936, the Club had become broader than its athletic origin. The name finally caught up.

Sometimes waived to bring members in. Sometimes reinstated to slow them down. Always present; the setting tuned to the moment.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 76, p. 81.

For the first time, *all classifications were closed.*

OCTOBER 1940

Service-suspense reinstated.

Before American entry into the war. An Army-and-Navy fee-free category was added for visiting GIs.

1943

650

Members lost during the war. The book records the loss as a threat to club finances.

1945

5,000

A record rebound — from postwar surge and pent-up demand.

1953

Juniors closed.

Postwar growth continues; the capacity instrument deployed again on a single category.

INTERPRETATION

1945 was the first deck-wide closure event in the Club's history. The instrument had been used on individual categories before. Now it was applied to the entire membership system at once. The Club was full.

Source: *Legacy of the Twenty-Six* (1991), p. 89, p. 91, p. 95.

INSTRUMENTS USED · 1956 WAITLIST · 1957 FREEZE

The waitlist is born.
The freeze goes on.

1956

First senior family waiting list.

Until 1956, closing a category meant exactly that — the door was closed, with no formal mechanism for the next applicant to take a number.

From 1956 onward, the Club had a list.

OCTOBER 1957 · ALL-TIME HIGH

8,700 *one-third juniors*

"All categories were immediately frozen."

— Legacy, p. 110

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 109, p. 110.

Protection means holding the *institution through the shock.*

01 · CONDITION

25%+ membership loss after October 1929. Federal 10% dues tax. World war. The Club required 1,250 senior members to prosper but had a stable base of 550 at the trough.

02 · MECHANISM

Family membership (1932). Dedicated retention role — Emil Piluso (1933). Fee fluidity. Service-suspense (1940). Army & Navy fee-free (1940). First deck-wide closure (1945). First waitlist (1956).

03 · STEWARDSHIP BALANCE

Preserve dues stability without abandoning members who could not pay. Protect community character through the rebuild. Keep the institution intact for the members who would return.

04 · LESSON FOR THE BOARD TODAY

In a shock, the Board's instruments are retention, suspension, and category design — not abandonment. *The 1933 retention hire is a 21st-century insight executed in the depths of the Depression.*

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), pp. 70, 75, 76, 89, 95, 109 · Stewardship framing per editorial direction.

Managing *Scarcity.*

Condition. 8,700 members in 1957. East-wing financing depended on incoming initiation revenue. By 1968, 7–8 years on the waitlist.

Mechanism. Freeze (1957). Rotating closure by category. Senior consolidation (1971). Equity rule changes 1973–80.

Stewardship. Manage capacity — while correcting equity gaps the rolls had encoded.

Lesson. Scarcity is a Board design choice. Public language can mask granular operational practice.

The freeze did not *stop net growth.*

LATE 1950S

8,500

Frozen, supposedly.

→

+37%

NET GROWTH

END OF THE 1960S

11,607

After ten years of "freeze."

UNRESOLVED

The book never reconciles the freeze with the documented growth.

See the companion memo on the freeze paradox.

THE APPARENT ANSWER

Categories were frozen and reopened repeatedly, with new categories created to absorb specific groups (associate women, juniors-of-members, etc.) without violating the headline cap.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 110, p. 158.

A "freeze" that grew *by 3,100 members.*

HISTORICAL RECORD

Same source records: *"All categories were immediately frozen"* (p. 110, October 1957) and *"Membership, about 8,500 in the late 1950s, increased more than 37 percent to 11,607 by the end of the '60s"* (p. 122). The same page: *"Every category would close at least once during the decade."*

UNRESOLVED

The book describes the freeze as a wall and the growth as continuous. Both cannot be simultaneously true under their plain meanings.

Companion memo (*freeze-paradox-memo.md*) walks the evidence: freeze as financing instrument, per-category rotation, the December 1965 Phase I opening, and the 1971 "moratorium lifted" language.

LESSON FOR THE BOARD TODAY

A single word the Board uses in public ("freeze," "moratorium," "lottery," "draw") can mask a granular instrument the Board operates in private. Public language and operational practice are not the same record. Future committees should expect this gap and document accordingly.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), pp. 110, 117, 121–122, 132 · Companion memo: freeze-paradox-memo.md (this project root).

HISTORICAL RECORD · 1968 · THE ONLY DOCUMENTED WAITLIST LENGTH

Not a queue. *A generation.*

7–8

YEARS ON THE SENIOR FAMILY WAITING LIST · 1968

VERBATIM

“The waiting list was seven to eight years.”

— *Legacy of the Twenty-Six*, p. 117

CONSEQUENCE

A child born when their family applied to MAC would be in school before their family was admitted.

The waitlist — born in 1956 as a stopgap — had become a structural feature of the Club by 1968. This 7-to-8 year figure is the only specific waitlist length the book documents.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 117.

A computer terminal — *and an ethical cleanup.*

OPERATIONAL MILESTONE

$7,350

Cost of the terminal — less than a 1990 floppy disc, the book notes. An "all-charge system" using "mechanized bookkeeping through data processing." *The first time MAC's membership and billing operations were not paper-bound.* Implemented to comply with the 1969 Tax Reform Act.

MORAL MILESTONE

"Questions regarding religion and nationality were deleted…"

— *Legacy of the Twenty-Six*, p. 132

"…from recommendation forms." *A 19th-century intake apparatus was finally retired.* The same year the Club consolidated its senior categories.

The membership rolls, *corrected.*

1973

DIVORCEES RETAINED

Before 1973, *"a woman lost her membership if she divorced — even if she had been the original member."* (p. 132) The 1973 rule change let divorcees remain.

The first social-equity correction in the membership rolls.

Feb 14, 1978

WOMEN'S FULL VOTE

Women voted for the first time at the annual meeting. The board "recanted: *'After reviewing the results ... the time has come to equalize membership status.'"* (p. 138)

Eighty-four years after the Ladies Annex opened.

Jan 1980

LEGACY BYPASS

A rule allowed members' children to bypass the waiting list when seeking senior status. *The first formal legacy mechanism in the book.*

Family continuity, made explicit.

Three rule changes — none with a facilities-or-finance justification. The Club is now using the membership rules to address social-equity questions.

Source: *Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 132, p. 138.*

A “freeze” was never a wall.
It was a Board control instrument.

01 · CONDITION

8,700 members in October 1957, one-third juniors. Facilities outgrown. East-wing financing depended on incoming initiation revenue. By 1968, senior families spent seven to eight years on the waitlist.

02 · MECHANISM

Freeze of all categories (1957). Rotating closure / reopening by category. 1971 consolidation of senior tiers. Removal of religion / nationality questions. Divorcee retention (1973). Women's full voting rights (1978). Legacy bypass (Jan 1980).

03 · STEWARDSHIP BALANCE

Manage capacity against facilities — while extending membership rights to constituencies the Club had previously excluded. The membership rolls were used to correct social-equity questions, not only to manage queues.

04 · LESSON FOR THE BOARD TODAY

Scarcity is a Board design choice, not an inevitability. The 1957–1971 record shows the Board oscillating intake by category and reframing eligibility under the cover of a single “freeze” word. *The vocabulary outside the room can mask the granularity inside it.*

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), pp. 110, 117, 121–122, 132, 138 · Stewardship framing per editorial direction.

Modernizing *Access.*

Condition. Binding external cap. Lottery oversubscription cycles. Silent attrition. COVID.

Mechanism. 1981 Goose Hollow accord. Audited lottery (1982–2020). 2021 bylaws & Big Draw. 2024–25 category and operations refresh.

Stewardship. Fair access against a ceiling; replace attrition; modernize policy without lowering the standard.

Lesson. The Board widened the path to consideration. It did not change who approves.

INSTRUMENT USED · 1981 · VOLUNTARY CAP AGREED WITH NEIGHBORS

For the first time, a cap *imposed from outside.*

VOLUNTARY CAP FOR THE YEAR 2000

~20,000

Negotiated with the Goose Hollow Foothills League (GHFL)

THE AGREEMENT

The Club entered into an agreement with the Goose Hollow Foothills League, the local neighborhood association, setting a voluntary membership cap of approximately 20,000 by the year 2000.

A neighbor-relations instrument, not a facilities instrument — though it functioned as both.

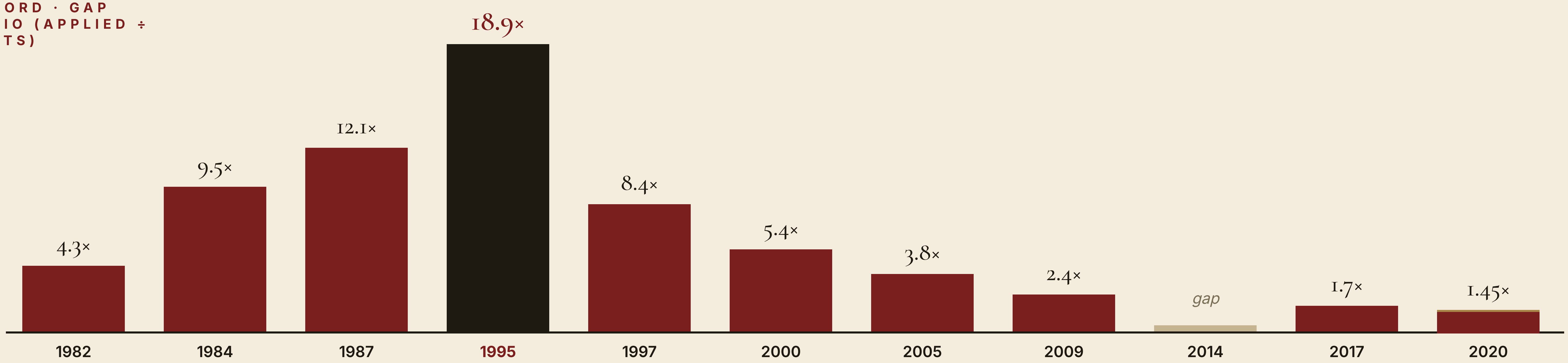
The first time MAC accepted a binding cap on its growth from an outside party. Every subsequent capacity decision in the book is bounded by the 1981 accord.

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), p. 152, p. 158.

1982 – 2020 · ELEVEN AUDITED CYCLES

Demand exceeded supply *in every documented cycle.*

HISTORICAL RECORD · GAP RATIO (APPLIED ÷ SLOTS)



Peak: 1995 — 1,885 applied for 100 slots. **Trough: 2020** — 948 applied for 652 waitlist slots. *2014 ratio omitted: total-applications figure not located in primary record (680 draws documented, source total missing).*

Source: 2011 SPC Report [S-01] · 2014 Intake Report [S-04] · 2017 Lottery Campaign Report [S-06] · 2020 Lottery Reports [S-08, S-09].

COVID did not change MAC's philosophy. *It forced the Club to say it out loud.*

WHAT 2020 EXPOSED

30% *Senior Individual U-40 attrition was on record before COVID.*

2014 Intake Report [S-04]

Applicants who waited **3–5 years** *"without meaningful connection to the club" were more likely to attrite.*

2015 Board Charge [S-05]

2020 made another silent cycle untenable. **1.45×** *oversubscribed; waitlist depleting.*

2020 Lottery Reports [S-08, S-09]

WRITTEN INTO THE 2021 PLAN

"…to replace attrition, stabilize dues revenue, maintain community character, and manage headcount."

— 2021 Big Draw Plan, objective statement [S-10]

The objective the Club had always shared — *finally named on paper, in policy, in the bylaws, in the FAQ.*

The lottery had values. They were assumed. After 2020, MAC put them on front street — in the bylaws, the FAQ, and the policy.

Source: 2011 SPC [S-01] · 2014 Intake [S-04] · 2015 Charge [S-05] · 2020 Reports [S-08, S-09] · 2021 Big Draw Plan [S-10].

FEBRUARY 26, 2021 · THE BYLAWS AMENDMENT

Three paths in.
One standard at the door.

HISTORICAL RECORD · VERBATIM, PRE- AND POST-AMENDMENT

"Only the Board may approve membership in the Club." — MAC Amended & Restated Bylaws, §2.2

PATH A — EXISTS SINCE 1891

Proposer + seconder.

The traditional vouch chain. Proposer (3+ years acquaintance with applicant) plus seconder (1+ year MAC standing). The chain operating since 1891.

PATH B — NEW: 2021

Proposer alone — <3 years.

A member sponsors an acquaintance known less than three years. The 3-year acquaintance requirement was removed for the Big Draw.

PATH C — NEW: 2021

Direct application.

Applicant applies without a proposer. The Membership Committee stands in as proposer — recommending directly to the Board under policies it develops and the Board approves.

The bylaws widened how an applicant reaches the Board vote. They did not change who casts the vote. The Membership Committee took on more of the welcome — not less.

Source: MAC Amended & Restated Bylaws, §2 (amended Feb 26, 2021) · Big Draw FAQ (June 23, 2021) · Waitlist Enhancement Memo (Mar 24, 2021): Robinett, Valdez, Hanna, Ticzon, Lee, Girard, Robb.

2024 – 2025 · THREE REFINEMENTS DURING HEALTH-SYSTEM FORMALIZATION

Category, billing, and *life-stage caught up.*

JAN 2025 · CATEGORY

Family of Two.

New Family-class category for two elected members without children, or a single elected member with one child. All children <18 count toward the account.

INITIATION · $7,000

NOV 2024 · OPERATIONS

Monthly Billing.

Quarterly and semi-annual cycles phased out. All members billed monthly — statements due the 25th. Annual total unchanged.

TOOLING · MAC PAY

FEB 2025 · LIFE-STAGE

Intermediate Earn Down.

Initiation discount that earns down with intermediate tenure. *Up to 50% off at 96 months.* Ages 18–26 (extendable to 30 with student status).

AUTO-APPLIED AT ELECTION

All three are modern membership instruments responding to modern conditions — not new philosophy. Each carries its own documented Board-approved rationale (FoT FAQ Oct 2024 · Monthly Billing FAQ Nov 2024 · Earn Down FAQ Feb 2025).

Source: Family of Two FAQ (Oct 29, 2024) · Monthly Billing FAQ (Nov 26, 2024) · Intermediate Earn Down FAQ (Feb 2025, Winged M).

Modernization meant making *the unwritten rules explicit.*

01 · CONDITION

Lottery oversubscription peaks at 18.9× in 1995; troughs at 1.45× in 2020. 30% U-40 attrition documented in the 2014 Intake Report. Silent waitlist eroded engagement. COVID forced the values question into writing.

02 · MECHANISM

1981 Goose Hollow cap. Audited lottery (1982–2020). Bylaws amendment (Feb 26, 2021). Big Draw / three paths. Family of Two (Jan 2025). Monthly billing (Nov 2024). Intermediate Earn Down (Feb 2025).

03 · STEWARDSHIP BALANCE

Balance fair access against a binding external cap. Replace attrition without overwhelming facilities. Address modern household and life-stage realities without lowering the standard for membership approval.

04 · LESSON FOR THE BOARD TODAY

Big Draw widened the path to consideration. It did not widen the standard at the door. The 2021 bylaws kept the Board's approval authority unchanged: *"Only the Board may approve membership in the Club."* (§2.2, verbatim.)

Source: 2011 SPC Report [S-01] · 2014 Intake Report [S-04] · 2020 Lottery Reports [S-08, S-09] · 2021 Big Draw Plan [S-10] · MAC Bylaws §2 (amended Feb 26, 2021) · FoT / Monthly Billing / Earn Down FAQs (2024–25).

From Ladies Annex to *equal governance.*

APR 3, 1894
Board minutes: ladies admitted two mornings/week. (Legacy p. 36)

1907
Ladies Annex has its own board of directors. (Legacy p. 36)

1940
Associate Woman category created. (Book Report)

1973
Rule change — divorcees retained. (Legacy p. 132)

FEB 14, 1978
Women vote for the first time at the annual meeting. (Legacy p. 132)

1983
Margaret "Peggy" Wood becomes first woman trustee. (Book Report)

1991
Marilyn Lindgren becomes first woman president. (Book Report, p. 7)

INTERPRETATION

"The mechanisms of inclusion changed step by step; the direction never reversed."

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), pp. 36, 132; Book Report pp. 2, 7.

Family *changed the Club.*

1891	*Bylaws permit "junior guests."* (Legacy p. 22)
1892	*Formal junior membership for sons and brothers.* (Legacy p. 22)
1908	*Intermediate classification (18–21) created.* (Legacy p. 31)
1932	*Family-class category — one bundled membership per household.* (Legacy p. 75)
1956	*First senior family waiting list — first formal queue in MAC history.* (Legacy p. 109)
1980	*Family Continuity Rule — children of members bypass waitlist.* (Legacy p. 138)

INTERPRETATION

"Family membership reshaped categories, waitlists, and the Club's very definition of continuity."

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), pp. 22, 31, 75, 109, 138.

QUESTIONS EVERY GENERATION ASKED

The answers changed.
The questions recurred.

1891	*How do we fund the Club?*
1908	*How do young members transition into full membership?*
1925	*Should we expand?*
1957	*Should membership freeze?*
1971	*How do we serve women equally?*
1981	*How many members are too many?*
1990	*Can future leaders still join?*
2026	*How do we monitor membership health?*

Every generation of the Board answered these questions with the instruments available to it.

Source: Framing derived from Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991), chapter openers; 2026 Board deck.

Governing Membership *Health.*

The Board charge of June 2026: define what membership health means for MAC — and how to monitor it.

JUNE 2026 · WORKING DEFINITION BEFORE THE BOARD

Membership health, *defined.*

WORKING DRAFT · TO RATIFY WITH PIPELINE SUBCOMMITTEE

Membership health is MAC's ability to welcome well-aligned members at a sustainable pace while retaining current members, preserving dues stability, strengthening community character, and carrying the Club's legacy forward.

HOW THE DEFINITION MAPS TO THE FIVE STEWARDSHIP RESPONSIBILITIES

WELCOME	RETAIN	PRESERVE	STRENGTHEN	CARRY FORWARD
Manage capacity & access	*Steward members already here*	*Dues stability*	*Community character*	*Prepare for next generation*

Source: Membership Health framework (June 2026 Board deck), slide 03 · Pipeline Subcommittee working draft · Editorial direction five-responsibility schema.

Three governing questions.
One signal each. One decision attached.

SIGNAL 01

Pipeline.

RUNWAY · PIPELINE ÷ RECENT NEW ACCOUNTS

Question. Does the pipeline support our election pace?
Decision. Open or hold a Big Draw cycle. Adjust pacing.
Risk monitored. Intake too thin to replace attrition — or too thick to absorb thoughtfully.

SIGNAL 02

Member Movement.

ACCOUNTS · DUES · RETENTION

Question. Are we replacing resignations — and retaining the members already here?
Decision. Adjust category policy, retention programs, proposer engagement.
Risk monitored. Net account loss · category mix drift · silent attrition (the U-40 problem).

SIGNAL 03

Revenue & Dues Mix.

NET DUES · PER ACCOUNT · % PREFERRED

Question. Is the dues base supporting the budget?
Decision. Initiation-fee planning. Category strategy. Dues structure.
Risk monitored. Dues base eroding under current members — the 2014 lesson.

Source: Pipeline Subcommittee deck (June 2026) — Erica (chair), Steve, Spencer, Sheri · Membership Health framework slide 04.

Each cadence has *a decision attached.*

MONTHLY

Membership Memo.

AUDIENCE · COMMITTEE & BOARD

Purpose. Anomaly detection. Reads each signal against prior month and 6-month rolling lens.

Decision attached. Should the Committee discuss this anomaly?

QUARTERLY

Trend Review.

AUDIENCE · MEMBERSHIP COMMITTEE

Purpose. Drift and pacing review. Reads 12-month rolling trajectories on all three signals.

Decision attached. Adjust intake pacing or category policy?

ANNUAL

Board Health Report.

AUDIENCE · COMMITTEE → BOARD

Purpose. Official record. Formal report on system health against benchmarks.

Decision attached. Set thresholds for the year ahead.

Source: Membership Health framework (June 2026 Board deck), slide 05 · Cadence & thresholds pending Pipeline Subcommittee ratification.

Proposers don't just bring in members. *They create future proposers.*

01
Proposer welcomes.
→
02
Applicant connects.
→
03
New member belongs.
→
04
Member retains.
→
05
Future proposer emerges.

"That's not a referral program. That's a self-reinforcing community." — Proposer Recognition Program, p. 9 (Feb 2026)

HOW PROPOSER RECOGNITION SUPPORTS THE THREE SIGNALS

SUPPORTS PIPELINE
Visible proposer culture sustains the proposer-driven demand the framework measures.

SUPPORTS MOVEMENT
One-year circle-back. Proposer nudge at peak retention risk — the intervention before resignation.

SUPPORTS CHARACTER
Soft accountability. Named sponsorship makes patterns of fit visible — the expectation made explicit.

SUPPORTS LEGACY
Genealogy of proposers. Who brought whom becomes legible — *the unbroken thread from 1891.*

Source: Proposer Recognition Program deck (Feb 2026), pp. 8–9 · Membership Health framework slide 09.

The instruments will change again.
The philosophy will not.

Over 135 years, MAC has employed many different membership mechanisms — initiation fees, categories, waitlists, freezes, lotteries, pipelines.

The mechanisms changed because the conditions changed.
The stewardship responsibility did not.

MOTION BEFORE THE BOARD

Accept Membership Health as the standing monitoring framework for 2026–27.

Authorize the Pipeline Subcommittee and Membership Committee to finalize benchmarks, cadence, and annual reporting format.

Sources: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991) · 2011 SPC [S-01] · 2014 Intake [S-04] · 2020 Reports [S-08, S-09] · 2021 Big Draw Plan [S-10] · 2024–25 FAQs · Pipeline Subcommittee (2026) · Proposer Recognition (Feb 2026) · Membership Health framework (June 2026).

Every generation changed the instruments.
No generation abandoned the responsibility.

- **1891** *Cash threshold established.*
- **1933** *Retention named as a discrete role (Piluso).*
- **1957** *Freeze — the Board confronted scarcity.*
- **1981** *Voluntary cap negotiated with neighbors.*
- **2026** *Membership Health adopted.*

"MAC has continuously adapted the mechanisms of membership while preserving the principles of stewardship."

— Book Report, p. 7 (synthesis of *Legacy of the Twenty-Six*, 1991)

Source: Legacy of the Twenty-Six (1991); institutional archive 1991–2026.

This is not a history of membership.

It is a documented history of how successive Boards governed membership through changing conditions while preserving the Club's long-term character.

Prepared per editorial direction, June 2026. Sources cited on every content slide.